When the era of Islam began, the name Esfara was applied to the district located south of what has been the main road connecting Ūš to Ḵojand; its towns Ṭâamāḵoš and Bāmkāḵoš, one mile apart, were probably located slightly to the north of the present town (Vasilii Vladimirovich Bartol'd, 1977). Ebn Ḥawqal mentions about the parti-coloured mountains with coal mines in the locality (Ḥawqal, 1967). Coal was mined there then (as now), sold at the low price of three donkey loads for one *derham*, and burnt for heat; the ashes were used for bleaching cloth (Spuler, 2015).

12 Muhammad Shaybāni Khān was (Y.Karasoy, 1998) one of the most formidable enemies of Babur and was also known as Abul-Fath Shaybāni Khān or Shayabak Khān or Shahi Beg Khān. He was originally named as 'Shibägh', which means wormwood or obsidian. He was born in the year AD 1451 to Sheikh Haidar, son of Abu'l-Khayr Khān and died on 2 December of AD 1510. As a powerful Uzbek leader, he consolidated various Uzbek tribes thereby laying the foundations for their dominance in Transoxiana and establishing the Khānate of Bukhara. He got the name Shaybāni for being descendant of Shiban (or Shaybān), the fifth son of Jochi (the eldest son of Genghis Khān).

13 This is summarized form of translated version of the *Baburnama* by Annette Susannah Beveridge,

14 Dervish or darvesh or darwīsh (from Persian: darvīsh) is an Islamic term. It broadly refers to the members of a Sufi fraternity (tariqah). (Britannica, 2009) But narrowly speaking it refers to a religious mendicant choosing to live with material poverty. (MacDonald, 2012) (Mansour Shaki, 2011) The latter usage is found particularly in Persian and Turkish (Derviş), corresponding to the Arabic term *faqir* (MacDonald, 2012). Their most common practice is Sama, which is associated with the thirteenth century mystic Rumi. The folklores speak of dervishes having ability to perform miracles and described with supernatural power. One more essential point that can't be ignored is that the Sufis have played instrumental role in bringing Islamic conversions.

15 This ancient, fortified residence of Ferghana rulers, known as Aksikent or Akhsi as it was called at that time, was built on the hill at the junction of two rivers—the Kasansai and the Syr Darya. In the times of Babur, Akhsi was the second largest city in the Ferghana Valley. Time and natural disasters had no mercy on it and today the ruins of Aksikent are buried under the huge mud hill in twenty kilometres south-west of Namangan.

The archaeologists discovered that fortified settlement with a citadel, called Ahshi or Ahsi existed on the territory of Ferghana Valley already in the third century BC as part of the Dayuan state. In the environs of Ahsi, just as in the whole Ferghana valley, people bred 'blood-sweating' war-horses whom